

Buxtehude, then at the cutting edge of German music. They also claimed that his accompaniments to chorales were far too elaborate. Bach in turn grumbled about the wide-ranging duties he had been given, which distracted him from the organ and his composition. He had no patience with the poor quality of local musicians, and once engaged in a violent brawl with a young bassoonist whose abilities he had insulted.

“ One **can’t fake things in Bach**, and if one gets all of them to work, **the music sings.** ”

HILARY HAHN, VIOLINIST